



VCT Floor Care: Stripping, Waxing and Maintenance

A layered VCT maintenance plan protects appearance, safety and the finish beneath daily traffic.



A layered VCT floor-care plan combines daily soil removal, periodic burnishing and scheduled restorative service.

AI-generated editorial image by OpenAI for AMI Commercial Cleaning Services, 2026. Editorial art for this article. Not a photograph of AMI staff or an AMI job site.

Commercial VCT lasts and looks better when daily soil removal, periodic machine work and restorative refinishing are managed as one system. Stripping and refinishing should be condition-based—not the only floor care the building receives.

The three layers of a VCT plan

1. Daily soil control

Entry matting, dust mopping or vacuuming, prompt spill response and correctly diluted cleaning solution keep grit from abrading the finish. Pay attention to edges, transitions and traffic lanes. Use signs and route work so occupants do not step onto a wet surface.

2. Periodic maintenance

Depending on the finish and manufacturer guidance, machine scrubbing, spray buffing or burnishing can remove embedded soil and restore a more even appearance. Frequency should follow traffic and condition rather than a fixed promise of constant high gloss.

3. Restorative stripping and refinishing

When wear is widespread, old finish may need to be removed and replaced in controlled coats. The area must be isolated, the chemistry must match the floor and finish system, and adequate cure time must be protected before reopening.

AMI can integrate floor care into a broader [commercial cleaning service plan](#) so daily cleaners and periodic technicians work from the same expectations.

When is stripping actually needed?

Look for finish failure that routine maintenance cannot correct: persistent traffic-lane wear, deep embedded soil, patchy appearance,

repeated finish buildup or damage that exposes the tile. First rule out incorrect dilution, worn pads, poor matting or an unrealistic maintenance interval.

Stripping too often increases labor, chemistry and downtime. Waiting too long can make restoration more difficult. A documented floor survey by area produces a better schedule than treating every corridor identically.

Safety and product controls

[OSHA requires walking-working surfaces](#) to be maintained in clean, orderly and, where feasible, dry conditions. Floor-care procedures should include signs, cord control, blocked access, slip-aware product selection and reopening criteria.

Follow the floor, finish and chemical manufacturers' instructions. Keep Safety Data Sheets available and train staff on dilution, personal protective equipment and ventilation. Facilities interested in products evaluated against human-health and environmental criteria can review [EPA Safer Choice](#), while confirming suitability for the exact floor-care step.

To scope traffic lanes, finish condition and downtime, [book a walkthrough with AML](#).

Frequently asked questions

Is VCT “wax” actually wax?

The common phrase “strip and wax” usually refers to removing and applying a commercial floor finish, often a polymer coating rather than traditional wax.

How often should VCT be stripped?

There is no reliable universal interval. Traffic, matting, daily maintenance, finish system and appearance standard determine the cycle.

Can burnishing replace stripping?

Burnishing can improve a compatible finish that still has integrity. It cannot correct complete finish failure, heavy buildup or every form of damage.



Walk the building. Then write the plan.

AMI scopes rooms, traffic, access, surfaces and standards before shift one across Delaware, Eastern Maryland and Southeastern Pennsylvania.

ami-cleaning.com/contact

Exact live logo

Locked artwork from ami-cleaning.com. Spelling, geometry and colors are unchanged.

Review draft 04 /
10